

CYBER SECURITY AWARENESS

Phishing Awareness Training

Spot it. Stop it. Report it.

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CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship · Task 2

Why phishing matters

36%

of data breaches involve phishing

Verizon Data Breach Investigations
Report, 2025

21 sec

median time for a person to click
a phishing link

Verizon Data Breach Investigations
Report, 2025

2.2x

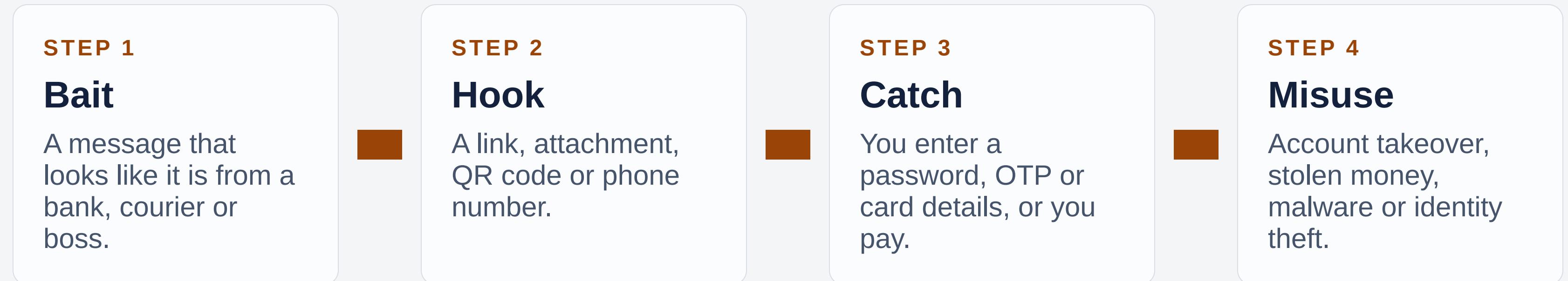
growth in reported cyber-security
incidents in India, from 10.29 lakh
(2022) to 22.68 lakh (2024)

Press Information Bureau, Government of
India

Attackers go after people first, because people are easier to trick than systems.

What is phishing?

Phishing is a social-engineering attack. The attacker pretends to be someone you trust, to trick you into giving away information, money or access.



Fun fact: the "ph" comes from "phreaking", early hacker slang for phone hacking.

Types of phishing

EMAIL

Email phishing

Mass emails posing as a bank, courier or online service.

EMAIL · TARGETED

Spear phishing

Built for one person, using details found about them.

SMS

Smishing

Fake texts about KYC updates, parcels or prizes.

PHONE CALL

Vishing

Callers pretending to be your bank, police or tech support.

QR CODE

Quishing

A QR code that opens a fake login or payment page.

EMAIL · MONEY

BEC scam

Business email compromise: a fake boss or vendor demands urgent payment.

Spot the red flags in an email

Example Bank Support

alerts@examplebank-kyc.example

URGENT: Your account will be blocked in 2 hours!

Dear Customer,

Your KYC has expired. Update now or your account will be closed permanently.

Verify my account

<http://examplebank.verify-now.example/login>

Attachment: KYC_Form.zip

- 1 Sender domain**
Compare it with the bank's real website.
- 2 Urgency and threats**
Real banks do not threaten closure within hours.
- 3 Generic greeting**
Your bank knows your name.
- 4 Link mismatch**
Hover, do not click, to preview the real address.
- 5 Odd attachment**
Never open ZIP or EXE files you did not expect.

Fake websites: read the address bar

Look-alike spelling

A digit or letter is swapped: l becomes 1.

`https://examp1ebank.example/login`

Real name as a subdomain

The real owner is the end part: verify-now.example.

`https://examplebank.example.verify-now.example/login`

Extra words

Banks rarely add words like secure or kyc.

`https://examplebank-secure-kyc.example/login`

A padlock only means the connection is encrypted. It does not mean the site is honest.

Social engineering: how they get you to act

Urgency

"Your account will be blocked in 2 hours."

Authority

"This is the police, your bank, or your manager."

Fear

"Your SIM will be cut off and a case will be filed."

Greed

"You won a prize. Claim your refund now."

Familiarity

"Hi, it's me. Can you check this file?"

The common thread: they want you to act before you think.

Real-world cases

2013–2015 · FAKE INVOICES

Google and Facebook invoice scam

A fake supplier sent realistic invoices. Over \$100 million was paid before it was caught.

Lesson: confirm payment changes by calling a known number.

2020 · PHONE PHISHING

Twitter account takeover

Attackers phoned staff posing as IT support, reached internal tools and hijacked famous accounts for a Bitcoin scam.

Lesson: verify any caller before sharing access.

2022 · MFA FATIGUE

Uber network breach

An attacker kept sending login approval prompts, then messaged the employee as IT support until one was approved.

Lesson: never approve a prompt you did not start.

Phishing in India

Fake KYC and PAN texts

An SMS says your account will be blocked unless you update details through a link.

UPI collect requests

You are asked to enter your PIN to "receive" money. You never need a PIN to receive.

Fake courier or bill alerts

Messages about a held parcel or an electricity cut-off, with a payment link.

"Digital arrest" calls

Callers posing as police or customs claim you are under arrest and demand money.

Lost money? Call 1930 immediately and report at cybercrime.gov.in.

How to protect yourself

Pause

Urgency is the attacker's tool. Take a minute before you act.

Check the source

Hover over links. Read the full address. Confirm the sender.

Turn on MFA

A second step can stop an attacker who has your password.

Unique passwords

Use a password manager. Never reuse a password.

Verify another way

Open the official app or call the official number yourself.

Report it

Tell your IT team or bank, so others are warned too.

Clicked a bad link? Act fast

- 1 Disconnect** Turn off Wi-Fi or data if you opened a file or installed something.
- 2 Change passwords** Use a clean device. Start with email and banking.
- 3 Call your bank** Block cards and stop payments. In India, call 1930 right away if money is lost.
- 4 Report it** Tell your IT or security team, and file a report at cybercrime.gov.in.
- 5 Watch your accounts** Check statements and login alerts for the next few weeks.

QUIZ · QUESTION 1 OF 5

An SMS says your account will be blocked in 2 hours unless you update KYC through a link. What do you do?

- A** Click the link quickly so the account stays open
- B** Reply with your account details to confirm
- C** Ignore the link and check with the bank's official app or number

ANSWER: C

Urgency plus a link is a classic smishing pattern. Check with the bank through its official app or number, never through the message.

QUIZ · QUESTION 2 OF 5

Which address is the real login page for Example Bank (examplebank.example)?

A `https://examplebank.example.verify-now.example/login`

B `https://login.examplebank.example`

C `https://examp1ebank.example/login`

ANSWER: B

The owner is the part before the first single slash, read right to left. B ends in examplebank.example. A belongs to verify-now.example, and C swaps an l for a 1.

QUIZ · QUESTION 3 OF 5

A caller says they are from the police, that you are under "digital arrest", and demands money over a video call. What is this?

A A scam. Real agencies never demand money over a video call

B A legal process you must obey

C A routine bank security check

ANSWER: A

This is vishing, mixing fear and authority. Hang up, do not pay, and report it by calling 1930 or at cybercrime.gov.in.

QUIZ · QUESTION 4 OF 5

Your manager emails you to urgently change a supplier's bank details before today's payment. What is the best first step?

- A** Do it, because the manager is busy and it is urgent
- B** Reply to the same email to confirm
- C** Confirm by calling a number you already have, not one from the email

ANSWER: C

Attackers control the email thread, so replying to it proves nothing. Verify payment changes through a second, trusted channel.

QUIZ · QUESTION 5 OF 5

Someone on the phone says they are from your bank and asks you to read out the OTP you just received. What do you do?

- A** Read it out, because they are from the bank
- B** Refuse, hang up and call the bank's official number
- C** Read out only the last three digits

ANSWER: B

An OTP is a key to your money. Banks never ask for it, and sharing any part of it helps the attacker.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

**Stop.
Think.
Verify.
Report.**

Do not click, reply or call back straight away.

Is it urgent, unexpected or too good to be true?

Use the official app, website or phone number.

Tell your IT team or bank. In India: 1930 and cybercrime.gov.in.

Sources and where to get help

Sources

- Verizon, 2025 Data Breach Investigations Report, as summarised in StationX's 2026 phishing statistics
- Press Information Bureau, Government of India, on curbing cyber fraud in Digital India
- Case summaries from public reporting: US Department of Justice (2019), New York DFS report on Twitter (2020), Uber security update (2022)

Where to get help in India

- National Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930
- Report online: cybercrime.gov.in
- For organisations: CERT-In, cert-in.org.in